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DJIA 48362.68 ▲ 227.79 0.47% NASDAQ 23428.83 ▲ 0.5% STOXX 600 586.75 ▼ 0.13% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 5/32, yield 4.170% OIL \$58.01 ▲ \$1.49 GOLD \$4,444.60 ▲ \$83.20 EURO \$1.1763 YEN 157.04

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Paramount amended** its offer for Warner Bros. Discovery after Larry Ellison agreed to personally guarantee \$40.4 billion of equity financing for the deal and publish records related to the family trust that backstops it. **A1, A6, B1**

◆ **The FDA approved** the first GLP-1 weight-loss pill—a tablet formulation of Novo Nordisk's Wegovy—ushering in a new era of the obesity-drugs revolution. **A1**

◆ **U.S. stocks advanced** broadly to start the holiday-shortened week, with the S&P 500 rising 0.6% to approach a record and the Dow and Nasdaq both gaining 0.5%. **B10**

◆ **The Trump administration** halted the construction of all U.S. offshore wind projects in the most significant action it has taken thus far against the burgeoning business. **A1**

◆ **Calpine, acquired by** Energy Capital Partners in 2017, is poised to become the most profitable private-equity deal of all time by dollar value. **B1**

◆ **Cintas, a big maker** of workplace products, submitted another offer to acquire smaller uniform supplier UniFirst, showing no signs of giving up after nearly four years of failing to get a deal done. **B1**

◆ **CBS News Editor in Chief** Bari Weiss defended her decision to pull a "60 Minutes" segment, saying the story wasn't ready for publication and "we simply need to do more." **B1**

◆ **Cosmetics maker Coty** appointed Procter & Gamble veteran Markus Strobel as its interim chief executive and board chair as the company reviews its consumer-beauty strategy. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **The president announced** that the Navy will build a new "Trump-class" battleship, which will become the centerpiece of his vision for a new "Golden Fleet." **A4**

◆ **The Education Department** said it is reviewing Brown University's security systems following the shooting that killed two students earlier this month. **A6**

◆ **A mistrial was declared** in the trial of former New York state aide Linda Sun as jurors deadlocked over allegations that she became rich from acting as a Chinese agent. **A3**

◆ **The FCC banned** all drones and critical components made in a foreign country, and all communications and video-surveillance equipment from two Chinese manufacturers. **A2**

◆ **Trump's appointment** of a special envoy for Greenland drew an angry response from Denmark and reignited its concerns about U.S. efforts to control the Arctic territory. **A8**

◆ **Authorities in Georgia** launched a manhunt for three detainees who escaped from an Atlanta-area jail. **A6**

◆ **Immigrants living** in the U.S. illegally will be paid \$3,000 if they leave the country voluntarily by the end of the year, a tripling of the sum now paid to those who self-deport. **A4**

◆ **Former Vice President** Mike Pence's political group is poaching top officials from the Heritage Foundation amid growing ideological fights within the conservative movement. **A4**

◆ **Died: Betty Reid Soskin**, 104, oldest park ranger. **A4**

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Car Bomb Kills a Russian General in Moscow



ANASTASIA BRASHKOVA/REUTERS

MYSTERY: An explosive device killed Lt. Gen. Fanil Sarvarov, who headed a training directorate for the Russian General Staff, on Monday as he was about to commute to work in Moscow. The Kremlin said Ukraine could have been involved. **A7**

China Is Making Gains in Tech, But Holes in Economy Remain

By BRIAN SPEGELE

BEIJING—In cities and small towns across China, two seemingly contradictory facts are simultaneously true: China is closing the gap with the U.S. for global technological dominance, and yet big parts of its economy are a mess.

Locally pioneered electric cars zip past deserted apartment blocks. Factory robots run by artificial intelligence churn out products that job-

less college graduates can't afford. State technology funds throw billions of dollars at money-losing startups even as the national debt surges to unprecedented levels.

The emergence of AI startup DeepSeek earlier this year showed China can challenge the U.S. in some of the world's most competitive technologies.

But Beijing's gains are coming at a steep cost, with the state's heavy-handedness in

directing investments wasting colossal amounts of money. The hundreds of billions of dollars China spends each year on domestic technology also eats away at the money for rural education, reinforcing the social safety net and other programs economists say are needed to put growth on a firmer footing.

"There is just massive misallocation that runs through the economy in multiple dimensions," said Loren Brandt,

an economist at the University of Toronto.

There are simply too many money-losing companies, with investments by local governments helping prevent weak ones from going under. Of the 129 brands selling electric cars and plug-in hybrids in China as of last year, only 15 are expected to be financially viable by 2030, according to consulting firm AlixPartners.

China now has more than

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Toxic Plane Fumes Blamed for Deaths

Doctors increasingly see link between contaminated cabin air, fatal illnesses

By BENJAMIN KATZ

An American Airlines pilot, Ron Weiland was 54 years old and in good physical shape when he mysteriously lost his ability to play pong.

During a game with his wife and two neighbors in October 2016, Weiland swung and missed the ball entirely when trying to serve. He missed easy shots that he would normally smash away.

Weeks later, after a cocktail at a friend's house in

Lake Worth, Fla., he started slurring his words. "You did just have one drink in there, right?" his wife Martha asked him.

Weiland made his last flight in May 2017, after he had trouble making his passenger announcements. In June of that year he was diagnosed with amyotrophic lateral sclerosis, or ALS, a rapid neurodegenerative disease that kills the brain cells needed to control muscles in the body.

Weiland died on Jan. 14,

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This Beer Goes Down Like Cognac

* * *

High-octane suds eat through cups, explode barrels

By LAURA COOPER

It takes a lot to get Jim Koch tipsy.

Koch, who runs the company that makes Samuel Adams, tries every batch before it is bottled. He pretty much always has a beer in his hand.

He recently met his match. This year his company concocted a new version of its highly boozy Utopias brand that is its strongest yet: a 30% alcohol by volume brew that's illegal in 15 states. Traditional Sam Adams is about 5%-6%.

"It is right up there with a

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INSIDE



JASON GAY

Why the college football playoffs have so many boring blowouts. **A16**

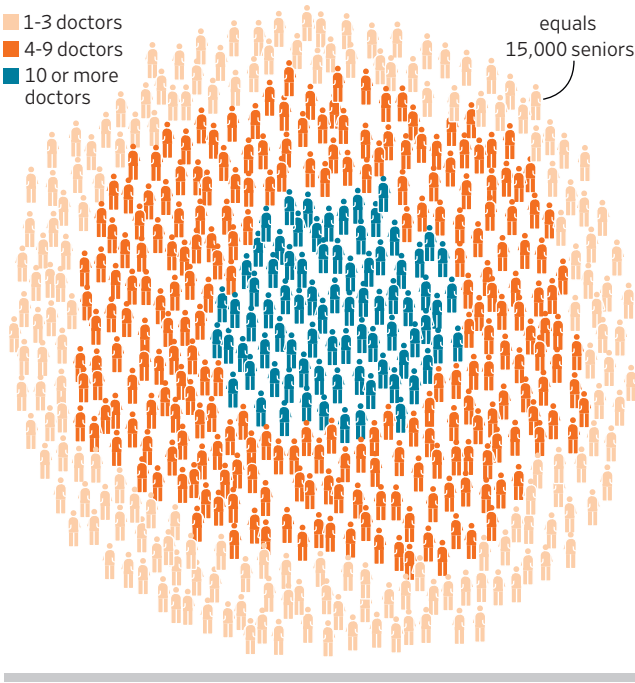
PERSONAL JOURNAL

A holiday guide to helping family members with their gadgets. **A11**

Rx Overload Hits Seniors

A Wall Street Journal analysis of Medicare data found that one in six of the 46 million seniors enrolled in the program's drug benefit were prescribed eight or more medications. **A10**

Number of seniors prescribed drugs by...



Wegovy's Pill Form Is Granted Approval by FDA

By PETER LOFTUS

U.S. regulators approved the first GLP-1 weight-loss pill—a tablet formulation of Novo Nordisk's Wegovy—ushering in a new era of the obesity-drugs revolution that is expected to broaden their use.

Novo Nordisk said Monday that it plans to start selling the new pill in the U.S. in early January, with a cash price of \$149 a month for the starting dose.

The Food and Drug Administration approval is a milestone because weekly shots such as Wegovy and Eli Lilly's Zepbound have dominated the anti-obesity market to date. Yet many people with excess weight don't take the shots due to cost, spotty insurance coverage and fear of needles.

Drug companies and ana-

lysts say pills will tap in to demand from people who don't want an injection or would prefer the cadence of a daily dose. Pills also offer the prospect of lower prices and better health-insurance coverage than injections, because pills cost less to make.

Novo Nordisk's new drug, which the company plans to call Wegovy pill, has the main ingredient semaglutide, which is the same ingredient in its injected diabetes drug Ozempic and weight-loss drug Wegovy.

Novo Nordisk has been selling a pill formulation of semaglutide, Rybelsus, that is approved specifically for Type 2 diabetes and not weight loss.

Semaglutide is a GLP-1 drug, which works by mimicking a gut hormone to reduce

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President Stops All Offshore Wind Projects

By JENNIFER HILLER

The Trump administration on Monday halted the construction of all U.S. offshore wind projects, a sweeping move aimed at hobbling one of the president's least favorite industries.

The Interior Department said it has paused the federal leases for five projects in the works from Massachusetts to Virginia "due to national security risks identified by the Department of War in recently completed classified reports." It is the most significant action the administration has taken thus far against the burgeoning U.S. business, which

already has faced financial setbacks in recent years due to soaring costs.

"Today's action addresses emerging national security risks, including the rapid evolution of the relevant adversary technologies, and the vulnerabilities created by large-scale offshore wind projects with proximity near our East Coast population centers," Interior Secretary Doug Burgum said.

The decision affects Vineyard Wind 1 off Martha's Vineyard; Revolution Wind, which is intended to deliver power to Rhode Island and Connecticut; Coastal Virginia Offshore Wind; and Sunrise Wind and

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